MAICON

FORWARD

Oct. 13-15, 2026

www.MAICON.ai

(AI-Generated Session Notes)

Building a Content Marketing Agentic Workflow

Date & time: Oct. 14, 10:00-10:35 AM EST
Track: Applied AI



Brian W. Piper

Founder, AIreFlow Solutions

- LinkedIn

Session Description

Most marketing teams have adopted AI tools. Few have built workflows where those tools actually talk to each other. Instead, they've created a collection of disconnected AI experiments, a prompt here, a chatbot there, a summarizer somewhere else, each producing isolated outputs that a human still has to stitch together manually. The result? AI is adding steps to your process instead of removing them.

The real unlock isn't finding the right tool. It's building a pipeline where the output of one AI becomes the input for the next, with human judgment applied at the strategic moments that actually matter, not babysitting every step. That's no longer a theoretical concept. It's an agentic workflow, and it transforms content marketing from a task-by-task grind into a scalable system.

In this hands-on workshop, you will build a complete content marketing workflow live. From initial research through final distribution, you will use an agentic pipeline where Gemini, ChatGPT, Claude, and NotebookLM each handle what they do best while passing context forward to the next stage.

You'll watch how a single strategic input becomes research briefs, content drafts, optimized assets, and distribution-ready packages without starting from scratch at every step. More importantly, you'll see exactly where human expertise enters the loop, and why those intervention points are what separate workflows that produce commodity content from workflows that produce content worth reading.

This isn't a tool tutorial. You'll leave with a replicable workflow architecture you can adapt for your own stack, your own team, and your own content strategy, whether you're a team of one or managing a department.

Key Quote

> *“AI can do a lot of things. It's up to us to decide what it should do.”* **- Brian W. Piper**

Session Summary

Brian W. Piper helps organizations integrate AI while keeping human expertise and experience front and center. He co-wrote the second edition of Epic Content Marketing, hosts the AI for You podcast, and teaches wingsuit skydiving. He opened with the story of Tim, an experienced skydiver flying very small parachutes whose speeds came close to the activation threshold of his automatic safety device, which deployed his reserve during a landing. Nothing was wrong with the gear or the technology; Tim failed to see the big picture. Brian's point: most of the time AI goes wrong, it's because humans haven't put the right guardrails in place.

Brian argued that most teams use AI in a scattered way and that the goal isn't more content but better content. When he loaded his books, newsletters, and podcast transcripts into AI and asked it to write like him, the output used his words but lacked his rationale, passion, and stories. The hidden cost of generic AI output is the time spent fixing it and the risk to the trust you've built with your audience.

His answer is the "human in the lead" sandwich: your experience, knowledge, and data form the bottom layer, AI does what it does well in the middle, and your judgment, taste, and responsibility form the top layer. He urged the audience to move from prompts to skills, explaining that a skill is essentially an SOP with guardrails and human checkpoints that can be refined every time something doesn't work. Rather than letting AI write the story, he recommends having AI interview you to pull the story out, and intentionally building skeptics into the process to counter AI's sycophancy.

He then walked through his agentic content engine, run by an orchestrator or master skill that guides each step, passes outputs between skills, carries frameworks and guardrails throughout, and keeps a build journal for later improvement. Skills cover data insight (six audits that once took three to four weeks and now take about three hours), ideas, a storybook of tagged stories, personas built from real customer data, perspective checks, AEO and discoverability, multi-model research checked for accuracy and synthesized in NotebookLM, interviews, collaboration, brand voice, critique, guardrails for bias, hallucinations, and regulations, and the 4 R's: repurpose, retarget, redistribute, and retire.

Brian closed with tracking, measurement, and channel playbooks, then advised building the engine one skill at a time before joining them under the orchestrator. Every skill, he said, is designed to keep the individual, the business, and the audience at the center of the content, and he ended by reminding the audience to keep their focus on the big picture.

Key Takeaways

- **Keep the human in the lead.** Brian's sandwich framework puts your knowledge and data at the start and your judgment and accountability at the end, with AI working in between.
- **Turn SOPs into skills.** A skill is an SOP plus guardrails and human checkpoints, and it can be updated every time you spot something that doesn't work.

- **Let AI interview you.** Bring the story yourself and have AI pull out the details, rather than asking it to write the story for you.
- **Build in a skeptic.** Because AI tends to be sycophantic, explicitly instruct it to critique, push back, and recommend edits rather than make them.
- **Orchestrate the engine.** A master skill passes outputs between skills, carries guardrails through every step, and logs a build journal so you can improve the process.
- **Track, measure, and retire.** Tag content by parent piece, channel, and AI use, review results regularly, and remove outdated content so AI isn't reading inaccurate information.